

USCC CTF Practice Challenge Tracker

Brandonn | USCC Eastern Cyber Camp | June 2026

Every flag found is a skill earned.

OVERALL PROGRESS

Metric	Value
Total Challenges Attempted	62
Total Challenges Solved	23
Total Points Earned	1,975
Overall Completion Rate	37.1%
Overall Summary	23 of 62 Solved 1,975 pts 37.1% Complete

CATEGORY BREAKDOWN

Category	Attempted	Solved	Points	Completion %	Section
Forensics	15	6	650	40.0%	See: Forensics
Web Exploitation	15	5	400	33.3%	See: Web Exploitation
Cryptography	12	5	300	41.7%	See: Cryptography
OSINT	10	4	300	40.0%	See: OSINT
Malware / Reverse Eng.	10	3	325	30.0%	See: Malware-RE
GRAND TOTAL	62	23	1,975	37.1%	5 Sections

QUICK STATS

Crypto 41.7%	Malware 30.0%	Forensics 650	~42 hrs
Best Rate	Lowest Rate	Top Points	Est. Hours

FULL CATEGORY SUMMARY - All Five Sections

Complete breakdown across all five competition categories.

Category	Attempted	Solved	Unsolved	Points Earned	Completion	Section
Forensics	15	6	9	650	40.0%	Forensics
Web Exploitation	15	5	10	400	33.3%	Web Exploit.
Cryptography	12	5	7	300	41.7%	Cryptography
OSINT	10	4	6	300	40.0%	OSINT
Malware / Reverse Eng.	10	3	7	325	30.0%	Malware-RE
GRAND TOTAL	62	23	39	1,975	37.1%	---

SCORING REFERENCE

Difficulty	Points Range	Description
Easy	25 - 100 pts	Beginner-level, foundational skills, typically one technique
Medium	100 - 200 pts	Intermediate difficulty, requires research and chaining steps
Hard	200 - 350 pts	Expert-level, multi-step exploitation, deep domain knowledge

STATUS LEGEND

Status	Meaning
Solved	Flag successfully captured. Points awarded and technique documented.
Unsolved	Attempted but not yet completed. Return before competition day.
Starred	High-priority - revisit immediately, appears in competition themes.

PLATFORM REFERENCE

Platform	URL	Best Used For
PicoCTF	picoctf.org	Beginner-friendly, year-round access
TryHackMe	tryhackme.com	Guided learning rooms with walkthroughs
HackTheBox	hackthebox.com	Advanced hands-on labs, competitive
CyberDefenders	cyberdefenders.org	Blue team and forensics focused labs
CTFtime	ctftime.org	Competition aggregator, event calendar
SANS Holiday Hack	holidayhackchallenge.com	Annual challenge, high-quality scenarios

Forensics

15 Challenges | 6 Solved | 650 pts | 40.0% Complete

15

Attempted

6

Solved

650

Points

40.0%

Rate

FORENSICS - CHALLENGE LIST

#	Challenge Name	Platform	Difficulty	Status	Points	Time (min)
1	Disk Image Puzzle	CyberDefenders	Easy	Solved	100	45
2	Memory Dump Mystery	CyberDefenders	Medium	Solved	200	90
3	Log Hunt	PicoCTF	Easy	Solved	75	30
4	Hidden in Plain Sight	CTFtime	Easy	Solved	75	25
5	The Deleted Evidence	TryHackMe	Medium	Solved	100	60
6	Email Trail	CyberDefenders	Medium	Solved	100	50
7	RAM Raider	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	300	120
8	Prefetch Pursuit	SANS Holiday Hack	Medium	Unsolved	200	90
9	EXIF Hunter	PicoCTF	Easy	Unsolved	150	75
10	Browser Artifacts	CyberDefenders	Medium	Unsolved	150	60
11	Linux Persistence	TryHackMe	Easy	Unsolved	150	60
12	Network Capture	CTFtime	Medium	Unsolved	200	90
13	Registry Rabbit Hole	CyberDefenders	Hard	Unsolved	250	120
14	Android Evidence	CTFtime	Medium	Unsolved	200	90
15	Volatile Vault	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	300	150
TOTALS (6 Solved)					650	1155

FORENSICS - DETAIL AND NOTES

Challenge Name	Sub-Type	Status	Points	Time (min)	Notes / Key Takeaway
Disk Image Puzzle	Disk Forensics	Solved	100	45	Autopsy - recovered deleted files
Memory Dump Mystery	Memory Forensics	Solved	200	90	Volatility pslist + cmdline
Log Hunt	Log Analysis	Solved	75	30	grep for suspicious entries

Hidden in Plain Sight	Steganography	Solved	75	25	steghide + exiftool
The Deleted Evidence	Disk Forensics	Solved	100	60	FTK Imager recovery
Email Trail	Email Forensics	Solved	100	50	Parsed .eml headers manually
RAM Raider	Memory Forensics	Unsolved	300	120	Need deeper Volatility practice
Prefetch Pursuit	Windows Artifacts	Unsolved	200	90	Review WinPrefetchView
EXIF Hunter	Metadata Analysis	Unsolved	150	75	exiftool GPS coordinates
Browser Artifacts	Browser Forensics	Unsolved	150	60	Chrome SQLite history DB
Linux Persistence	Linux Forensics	Unsolved	150	60	Cron jobs and systemd timers
Network Capture	Network Forensics	Unsolved	200	90	Wireshark + tshark filters
Registry Rabbit Hole	Windows Registry	Unsolved	250	120	Registry Explorer + RECmd
Android Evidence	Mobile Forensics	Unsolved	200	90	ADB + ALEAPP
Volatile Vault	Memory Forensics	Unsolved	300	150	Kernel-level plugin needed

FORENSICS - PERSONAL NOTES

Web Exploitation

15 Challenges | 5 Solved | 400 pts | 33.3% Complete

15

Attempted

5

Solved

400

Points

33.3%

Rate

WEB EXPLOITATION - CHALLENGE LIST

#	Challenge Name	Platform	Difficulty	Status	Points	Time (min)
1	SQL Injection 101	PicoCTF	Easy	Solved	50	25
2	XSS Attack Lab	TryHackMe	Easy	Solved	50	30
3	IDOR Exposed	HackTheBox	Medium	Solved	100	45
4	JWT Juggle	CTFtime	Medium	Solved	100	60
5	SSRF Strike	CyberDefenders	Medium	Solved	100	75
6	Command Injection	TryHackMe	Medium	Unsolved	150	90
7	File Upload Bypass	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	200	120
8	Path Traversal	PicoCTF	Easy	Unsolved	75	40
9	Broken Auth	CTFtime	Medium	Unsolved	150	80
10	XXE Attack	CyberDefenders	Hard	Unsolved	200	110
11	CSRF Lab	TryHackMe	Easy	Unsolved	75	35
12	WebSocket Hijack	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	300	150
13	Open Redirect	PicoCTF	Easy	Unsolved	75	30
14	LFI Discovery	CTFtime	Medium	Unsolved	150	70
15	RFI Exploit	CyberDefenders	Hard	Unsolved	200	100
TOTALS (5 Solved)					400	1060

WEB EXPLOITATION - DETAIL AND NOTES

Challenge Name	Sub-Type	Status	Points	Time (min)	Notes / Key Takeaway
SQL Injection 101	SQL Injection	Solved	50	25	sqlmap -u to grab flag
XSS Attack Lab	Reflected XSS	Solved	50	30	Simple script alert payload
IDOR Exposed	IDOR	Solved	100	45	Changed user_id param

JWT Juggle	Auth Bypass	Solved	100	60	None algorithm attack
SSRF Strike	SSRF	Solved	100	75	Internal metadata endpoint
Command Injection	Cmd Injection	Unsolved	150	90	Try semicolon chaining
File Upload Bypass	File Upload	Unsolved	200	120	MIME type + extension bypass
Path Traversal	LFI / Path	Unsolved	75	40	../../../../etc/passwd
Broken Auth	Authentication	Unsolved	150	80	Session fixation attack
XXE Attack	XML Injection	Unsolved	200	110	Entity expansion
CSRF Lab	CSRF	Unsolved	75	35	Forge form submission
WebSocket Hijack	WebSocket	Unsolved	300	150	WSS cross-origin attack
Open Redirect	Redirect	Unsolved	75	30	URL param manipulation
LFI Discovery	LFI	Unsolved	150	70	PHP wrappers
RFI Exploit	RFI	Unsolved	200	100	Remote include via allow_url

WEB EXPLOITATION - PERSONAL NOTES

Cryptography

12 Challenges | 5 Solved | 300 pts | 41.7% Complete

12

Attempted

5

Solved

300

Points

41.7%

Rate

CRYPTOGRAPHY - CHALLENGE LIST

#	Challenge Name	Platform	Difficulty	Status	Points	Time (min)
1	Caesar Cipher	PicoCTF	Easy	Solved	50	20
2	Base64 Decode	CTFtime	Easy	Solved	25	10
3	RSA Basics	CyberDefenders	Medium	Solved	75	45
4	Vigenere Vex	TryHackMe	Medium	Solved	75	50
5	AES Oracle	HackTheBox	Medium	Solved	75	60
6	Hash Cracker	PicoCTF	Easy	Unsolved	50	30
7	Elliptic Curves	CTFtime	Hard	Unsolved	250	120
8	XOR Masters	TryHackMe	Easy	Unsolved	50	25
9	Padding Oracle	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	300	150
10	PRNG Weakness	CyberDefenders	Hard	Unsolved	200	100
11	Frequency Analysis	CTFtime	Medium	Unsolved	100	55
12	DES Decrypt	PicoCTF	Medium	Unsolved	100	60
TOTALS (5 Solved)					300	725

CRYPTOGRAPHY - DETAIL AND NOTES

Challenge Name	Sub-Type	Status	Points	Time (min)	Notes / Key Takeaway
Caesar Cipher	Classical	Solved	50	20	ROT-13 variant, brute forced
Base64 Decode	Encoding	Solved	25	10	Layered b64 decode
RSA Basics	Asymmetric	Solved	75	45	Small e, Wiener attack
Vigenere Vex	Classical	Solved	75	50	Kasiski + IC method
AES Oracle	Symmetric	Solved	75	60	ECB mode block swap
Hash Cracker	Hashing	Unsolved	50	30	Hashcat wordlist attempt

Elliptic Curves	ECC	Unsolved	250	120	Invalid curve attack
XOR Masters	XOR	Unsolved	50	25	Known plaintext XOR
Padding Oracle	Block Cipher	Unsolved	300	150	PKCS7 oracle attack
PRNG Weakness	PRNG	Unsolved	200	100	Mersenne Twister state
Frequency Analysis	Classical	Unsolved	100	55	Mono-alphabetic subst.
DES Decrypt	Symmetric	Unsolved	100	60	Weak key detection

CRYPTOGRAPHY - PERSONAL NOTES

OSINT

10 Challenges | 4 Solved | 300 pts | 40.0% Complete

10

Attempted

4

Solved

300

Points

40.0%

Rate

OSINT - CHALLENGE LIST

#	Challenge Name	Platform	Difficulty	Status	Points	Time (min)
1	Username Hunt	CTFtime	Easy	Solved	50	25
2	Geolocation Challenge	PicoCTF	Easy	Solved	75	40
3	Metadata Miner	CyberDefenders	Medium	Solved	100	55
4	Dark Web Trail	TryHackMe	Medium	Solved	75	50
5	Reverse Image Search	CTFtime	Easy	Unsolved	50	30
6	Phone Number Trace	HackTheBox	Medium	Unsolved	150	75
7	LinkedIn Lookout	CyberDefenders	Medium	Unsolved	150	70
8	Shodan Search	TryHackMe	Hard	Unsolved	200	100
9	Domain Digger	PicoCTF	Easy	Unsolved	75	35
10	Corporate Recon	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	300	150
TOTALS (4 Solved)					300	630

OSINT - DETAIL AND NOTES

Challenge Name	Sub-Type	Status	Points	Time (min)	Notes / Key Takeaway
Username Hunt	Social Media	Solved	50	25	Sherlock tool
Geolocation Challenge	Geolocation	Solved	75	40	Google Street View
Metadata Miner	Metadata	Solved	100	55	exiftool GPS embed
Dark Web Trail	Dark Web	Solved	75	50	Tor hidden service
Reverse Image Search	Image OSINT	Unsolved	50	30	TinEye + Google Lens
Phone Number Trace	Phone OSINT	Unsolved	150	75	PhoneInfoaga
LinkedIn Lookout	Social Media	Unsolved	150	70	OSINT framework
Shodan Search	Network OSINT	Unsolved	200	100	Banner grab + filters

Domain Digger	DNS OSINT	Unsolved	75	35	whois + dig
Corporate Recon	Corp. OSINT	Unsolved	300	150	LinkedIn + job postings

OSINT - PERSONAL NOTES

Malware / Reverse Eng.

10 Challenges | 3 Solved | 325 pts | 30.0% Complete

10

Attempted

3

Solved

325

Points

30.0%

Rate

MALWARE / REVERSE ENG. - CHALLENGE LIST

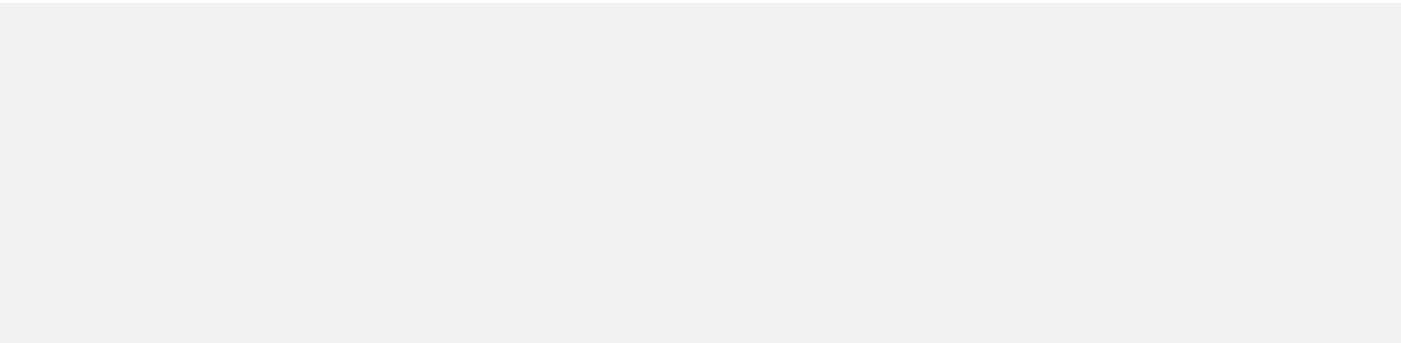
#	Challenge Name	Platform	Difficulty	Status	Points	Time (min)
1	Static Analysis 101	TryHackMe	Easy	Solved	75	40
2	String Extractor	PicoCTF	Easy	Solved	100	50
3	Packed Binary	CyberDefenders	Medium	Solved	150	80
4	Anti-Debug	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	300	150
5	Ransomware Sample	CyberDefenders	Hard	Unsolved	300	180
6	Shellcode Study	CTFtime	Medium	Unsolved	200	100
7	Obfuscated Script	TryHackMe	Medium	Unsolved	150	90
8	Rootkit Hunt	HackTheBox	Hard	Unsolved	350	200
9	Network Malware	CyberDefenders	Medium	Unsolved	200	110
10	Firmware Reverse	CTFtime	Hard	Unsolved	300	160
TOTALS (3 Solved)					325	1160

MALWARE / REVERSE ENG. - DETAIL AND NOTES

Challenge Name	Sub-Type	Status	Points	Time (min)	Notes / Key Takeaway
Static Analysis 101	Static Analysis	Solved	75	40	strings + file + die
String Extractor	Strings	Solved	100	50	FLOSS for obfuscated strings
Packed Binary	Unpacking	Solved	150	80	UPX unpack + Ghidra
Anti-Debug	Anti-Analysis	Unsolved	300	150	IsDebuggerPresent patches
Ransomware Sample	Malware Analysis	Unsolved	300	180	Key extraction from memory
Shellcode Study	Shellcode	Unsolved	200	100	scdbg + x64dbg
Obfuscated Script	Deobfuscation	Unsolved	150	90	JS/PS de-obfuscation
Rootkit Hunt	Rootkit	Unsolved	350	200	Kernel module analysis

Network Malware	Network	Unsolved	200	110	Wireshark C2 traffic
Firmware Reverse	Firmware	Unsolved	300	160	binwalk + squashfs

MALWARE / REVERSE ENG. - PERSONAL NOTES



CTF TOOLS QUICK REFERENCE

Category	Key Tools
Forensics	Autopsy, Volatility, FTK Imager, ALEAPP, Wireshark, exiftool, strings
Web Exploit	Burp Suite, sqlmap, ffuf, dirb, nikto, curl, Postman, jwt_tool
Cryptography	CyberChef, hashcat, john, openssl, pwntools, SageMath, factordb
OSINT	Maltego, Shodan, theHarvester, Sherlock, Recon-ng, OSINT Framework
Malware / RE	Ghidra, x64dbg, IDA Free, FLOSS, pestudio, scdbg, binwalk, dnSpy

STUDY PRIORITY MATRIX

Category	Priority Challenges	Reason
Web Exploitation	Command Injection, File Upload, XXE Attack	High - common in competitions
Forensics	RAM Raider, Registry Rabbit Hole, Volatile Vault	High - memory weak area
Cryptography	Padding Oracle, Elliptic Curves	Medium - needs math review
OSINT	Shodan Search, Corporate Recon	Medium - expand toolset
Malware / RE	Anti-Debug, Ransomware, Rootkit Hunt	High - hardest unsolved

TRACKER NOTES

- This tracker covers practice challenges completed for USCC Eastern Cyber Camp preparation.
- All challenge data is self-reported. Update Status and Notes columns after each session.
- Aim to solve at least 2 unsolved challenges per category before competition day.
- Points shown are approximate platform values. Actual CTF scoring may vary.
- Cross-reference this tracker with your personal notes and write-ups folder.